

Chenzhe Zhang

Phone : +1 (984)2605423 | Email : cz222@duke.edu

EDUCATION

Duke University	Aug 2024 - May 2026
M.A. Economics (Dean's Research Award for Master's Students)	Durham, USA
Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (XJTLU)	Sep 2020 - Jun 2024
BSc Economics and Finance (First Honor Degree)	Suzhou, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Policy Evaluation, Machine Learning and Causal Inference.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Effect of the Wind Farm Construction on Local Climate Change	May 2025 - Present
Research Assistance	
- Employed an event-study and staggered Difference-in-Differences (DiD) design to examine the impact of wind-farm construction on local atmospheric conditions. - Preliminary evidence suggests that wind-farm construction may reduce the frequency of thermal inversions, potentially affecting the validity of using thermal inversions as an instrumental variable.	
Supervisor: Dr. Zhenxuan Wang	
Clear Sky, Clear Minds- Emperical Evidence based on NSFC	Sep 2023 - Present
Undergraduate Final Year Project	
- Used air pollution from upwind cities as an instrumental variable and compiled daily weather and air quality data, along with annual NSFC research proposal records from 2013 to 2019. - Updated Results demonstre that 2-3 month exposure to air pollution before applicaiton will decrease the grant proposals submitted.	
Supervisor: Dr. Shuyang Si, Dr. Nakaya Kakuda	
The Shadow under Holiday: Changes of Consumer Food Safety Confidence during the Spring Festival in China	Sep 2024 - Present
Project Member	
- Provided feedback on and helped refine structural equation models - Result suggests Big Five personality traits shape Chinese consumers' food-safety confidence through economic perceptions and trust in actors, and documented especially low confidence among highly neurotic consumers during the Spring Festival <i>Manuscript under revision at Food Policy</i>	
Sepervisor: Dr. Shuyang Si; Dr. Nakaya Kakuda	
Dynamic Optimization of Distributed Photovoltaic (DPV) Systems	Sep 2025 - Dec 2025
Course Project	
- Developed a continuous-time optimal control model in which a social planner jointly chooses DPV subsidies and direct abatement to manage pollution. - Preliminary calibration shows an optimal front-loaded, declining subsidy path and highlights that improving grid efficiency and strengthening rural households' trust in policy are crucial to avoiding inefficient subsidy use.	
Supervisor: Prof. Martin Smith	
Government Endorsement and Voter Skepticism: An Experiment of Selective Disclosure in Political Communication	Feb 2025 - Jun 2025
Capstone Project	
- Developed theoretical predictions on voter behavior when facing governments with varying policy preferences. - Designed a controlled experiment to test how perceived government bias affects voter decision-making.	
Supervior: Dr. Pellumb Reshidi	
Long-Term Effects of Education on Earnings and Psychological Well-Being	Jan 2025 - Jun 2025
Capstone Project	
Utilized data from the Chinese Family Panel Survey (2010–2022) and Regression Discontinuity to examine the effects of the College Entrance Examination Expansion Policy and the Nine-Year Compulsory Education Policy.	

- Preliminary results suggest a diminishing correlation of education on income over time, but a parabola shape correlation on mental health. *(Details are here)*
- Superviosr: Prof. Atila Abdulkadiroglu
- Policy Effects on Real Estate Supply Behaviors in Suzhou** Jun 2023 - Sep 2023
- Undergraduate Research Assistance
- Collected detailed data on underground garage column spacing in residential complexes across Suzhou.
 - Employed Regression Discontinuity to evaluate the impact of the 2013 air defense parking rent regulation.
 - Findings suggest that the policy unintentionally reduced the construction quality of standard residential garages. *(Details are here)*
- Supervisor: Dr. Shuyang Si
- The Effect of the Nutrition Label Education (NLE) on Consumers' Healthy Diet Choices** Jun 2022 - Sep 2022
- Undergraduate Research Assistance
- Designed and conducted a field experiment by administering surveys bt taking the NLE intervention at a commercial center.
 - Field trial result shows that the NLE significantly increases consumers’ willingness to pay for products with lower fat and sodium content, but not for reductions in other nutrients. *(Details are here)*
- Supervisor: Dr. Shuyang Si

PRESENTATIONS

"Clear Sky, Clear Minds-Empirical Evidence based on NSFC (updated)" Department of Economics, Rice University. Oct. 2025

"Clear Sky, Clear Minds-Empirical Evidence based on NSFC" Department of Economics, Duke Universiy. Oct. 2024

"Policy Effect on Real Estae Supply Behaviors in Suhzhou" Seminar. International Business School Suzhou (IBSS), Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool Univrsity. Sep 2023

"The Effect of the Nutrition Label Education on Conusmer" Healthy Diet Choices". Seminar. International Business School Suzhou (IBSS), Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool Univrsity. Oct 2022

HONORS AND AWARDS

- | | |
|--|----------|
| Dean's Research Award for Master's students | Otc 2025 |
| International Business School Suzhou Summer Undergraduate Research Presentation, First Place | Sep 2023 |
| University Academic Achievement Award (first 10% within cohort) | Aug 2023 |

SKILLS

- **Computer Languages:** M.S.Office, STATA, Python, R, MATLAB
- **Languages (Ordered by Proficiency):** Mandarin, English

Last Update

Oct 2025